THE SLEEP GUIDE

SLEEP BETTER. EVERYTHING GETS EASIER.

A simple system to sleep better, recover faster and make fat loss feel a whole lot easier. **No science lecture. Just the stuff that works.**

Mark Davies
Founder, Zenith Fit

Structure beats motivation. Every single time.

FIRST THINGS FIRST

WHY SLEEP MATTERS

Sleep is the pillar everyone skips, and it's the one that quietly makes the other four harder. When you're short on sleep, **you're fighting your own body all day.**

WHEN SLEEP IS POOR

- **Hunger goes up.** Your hunger hormones shift and you genuinely want more food.
- **Cravings get louder.** Sugar and quick energy become much harder to say no to.
- **Training feels heavier.** The same weights feel harder and recovery slows down.
- **Mood and motivation drop.** Small things feel bigger and the plan feels like a chore.
- **Stress rises.** And stress makes sleep worse. It's a loop, and we're going to break it.

THE BOTTOM LINE

You can still make progress on poor sleep. Sleep is the lever that makes progress feel easier. We're stacking the odds in your favour.

7 to 9 hours

in bed, most nights. That's your target.

Quality first

If life's busy, improve how well you sleep before you chase more of it.

YOUR SCORECARD

THE ZENITH SLEEP SCORE

Each habit is worth 1 point. **Aim for 8 out of 10.** Hit 8 and you're winning. Nobody gets 10 every night, and they don't need to.

1. **Same wake up time,** within an hour, every day.
2. **Morning light within 30 minutes of waking.** 5 to 10 minutes outside.
3. **Caffeine cut off** at least 8 hours before bed.
4. **Last meal finished** 2 to 3 hours before bed.
5. **A 10 minute wind down,** the same one each night.
6. **Screens off or dimmed** in the last hour.
7. **Bedroom cool, dark and quiet.**
8. **No scrolling in bed.**
9. **Wake in the night?** You don't start planning tomorrow.
10. **Alcohol kept low,** or none at all.

8/10 Score yourself tonight. Whichever 2 or 3 you're missing, that's your starting point. **Pick one and nail it this week.**

THE ESSENTIALS

THE 3 NON NEGOTIABLES

If you do nothing else in this guide, **do these 3.** Everything else gets built on top of them.

1

FIXED WAKE UP TIME

Set it and protect it. Even when bedtime moves, your wake time anchors your body clock. This matters more than anything else on the list.

2

CAFFEINE CUT OFF

Caffeine hangs around for far longer than people think. If you sleep light or wake a lot, this is usually the first fix. **Nothing after midday,** or 8 hours before bed.

3

A WIND DOWN

Your body needs a signal that the day's done. Not a full spa night. Just 10 minutes you repeat every night so your brain learns what's coming.

YOUR 10 MINUTE WIND DOWN

Pick one from each. Keep it the same every night. Repetition is what makes it work.

BODY

2 minutes of slow breathing, a light stretch for hips, back and chest, or a hot shower.

BRAIN

Write 3 lines: what went well, what needs doing tomorrow, one thing you're grateful for. Or read 5 pages.

ROOM

Lights down. Phone out of reach. Clothes ready for tomorrow. Water by the bed.

SETUP

YOUR BEDROOM

TEMPERATURE

A cool room helps you drop off faster and stay asleep. Waking up hot? Fix this first: lighter duvet, window open, fan on.

DARKNESS

If you can see your hand, it's too bright. Blackout curtains or a sleep mask. Dark tells your brain it's time.

SOUND

If noise wakes you, use white noise. If your mind wakes you, the wind down is your fix.

THE PHONE RULE

Charge it away from the bed. The bed's for sleep. This one habit changes more than people expect.

FOOD, TRAINING AND ALCOHOL

FOOD

Finish eating 2 to 3 hours before bed. Going to bed stuffed means lighter sleep.

Hungry at night? Plan it. A small protein snack 60 to 90 minutes before bed: Greek yoghurt, cottage cheese, a shake, chicken slices.

TRAINING

Training helps sleep. Timing matters.

- Finish 2 hours before bed if you can
- Cool shower after a late session
- No pre workout after mid afternoon

ALCOHOL

It knocks you out, then wrecks the quality of your sleep.

- 2 drinks max
- Stop 3 hours before bed
- Water before sleep
- Expect a slightly flat next day, and plan for it

TROUBLESHOOTING

WHEN SLEEP WON'T COME

Don't panic. A bad night happens to everyone. **Here's exactly what to do.**

CAN'T FALL ASLEEP

Use the 20 minute rule. Awake for about 20 minutes? Get up. Low light, no phone. Read something dull or do slow breathing, then go back to bed when you feel sleepy. Lying there fighting it teaches your brain that bed is where you lie awake.

WAKING IN THE NIGHT

Waking up is normal. Do nothing dramatic.

1. Don't check the time.
2. 10 slow breaths. In through the nose, out for longer than in.
3. Relax your jaw, shoulders and hands.
4. Still awake? Use the 20 minute rule.

WAKING AT 3AM?

It's usually one of these: stress, alcohol, being too hot, late caffeine, a heavy late meal or a wake time that keeps moving. **Find your culprit and fix that one thing first.**

YOUR 7 DAYS

THE 7 DAY SLEEP RESET

Add one thing a day. Keep the ones that work. **Most people feel the difference by day 4 to 7.**

1. **Day 1.**
   Set your wake time and stick to it.
2. **Day 2.**
   Morning light within 30 minutes of waking.
3. **Day 3.**
   Your caffeine cut off.
4. **Day 4.**
   Nothing to eat 2 to 3 hours before bed.
5. **Day 5.**
   Your 10 minute wind down.
6. **Day 6.**
   Bedroom cool and dark.
7. **Day 7.**
   The weekend rule.

THE WEEKEND RULE

YOUR WAKE TIME STAYS WITHIN AN HOUR. ALL WEEKEND.

Most people wreck their sleep Friday to Sunday, then feel broken on Monday. Bedtime can move a bit. **Your wake time stays put.** This one rule upgrades your whole week.

MAKE IT YOURS

YOUR SLEEP COMMITMENT

Fill this in. Be specific. **A plan you've written down is a plan you'll actually follow.**

My wake up time is

My caffeine cut off is

My wind down starts at

My sleep score target is

8 out of 10

My 10 minute wind down is

STILL SLEEPING BADLY? CHECK THESE

Fix the obvious before you overcomplicate it.

- [ ] Am I having caffeine too late?
- [ ] Am I going to bed wired, without a wind down?
- [ ] Am I too hot in bed?
- [ ] Am I eating too close to bed?
- [ ] Am I scrolling in bed?
- [ ] Is my wake time all over the place?
- [ ] Am I drinking most nights?

Still struggling after a couple of weeks of this? Mention it in your Friday check in and we'll look at it together. If it's been going on for a long time, it's worth a chat with your GP too.